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November 26, 2025

Hiring Committee
Berkeley Art Museum and Pacific Film Archive
University of California, Berkeley

Dear Hiring Committee,

I am writing to express my interest in the Website Systems Developer & Manager position at BAMPFA. As a Berkeley alumnus and full-stack software engineer with extensive experience in database architecture, API integration, and platform migration projects, I am excited about the opportunity to contribute to BAMPFA's digital infrastructure during this critical transition period.

My recent work at Centigrade demonstrates my ability to execute the type of technical overhaul BAMPFA requires. I rewrote critical API services in FastAPI and optimized database schema and indexing to support a 5x throughput increase while reducing latency by 60%. This experience directly translates to maintaining BAMPFA's PostgreSQL database and ensuring efficient data relationships between the CMS and backend systems. I also redesigned the frontend using React and Tailwind CSS, improving accessibility scores from 30 to 90—experience that will prove valuable in ensuring BAMPFA's new WordPress site meets WCAG 2.1 standards.

At CarbonSustain, I architected a blockchain-based platform from prototype to MVP as the founding engineering team lead. I built Node.js backends with FastAPI microservices, integrated Angular/TypeScript frontends with PostgreSQL, and designed AWS infrastructure using Terraform. This work required coordinating with stakeholders, managing external vendors, and maintaining clear technical documentation—skills essential for serving as BAMPFA's in-house technical lead during the website redevelopment project. I established CI/CD pipelines that enabled zero-downtime releases, experience that aligns with maintaining proper version control and deployment workflows for BAMPFA's public site.

My technical skillset encompasses the specific technologies mentioned in the job description. I have strong proficiency in PostgreSQL, having designed schemas and implemented RESTful APIs for production systems. I'm experienced with Python, JavaScript, and PHP, and have worked extensively with cloud infrastructure (AWS EC2, S3, CloudFront) and modern DevOps practices (Docker, Kubernetes, CI/CD). While I haven't worked directly with Drupal 7 or WordPress at scale, my experience migrating systems and learning new frameworks quickly—evidenced by my work across FastAPI, Django, Flask, React, Angular, and blockchain platforms—positions me well to manage both the legacy Drupal site and the WordPress transition.

As a Berkeley graduate and Regents' Scholar, I have deep appreciation for BAMPFA's mission as a forum for cultural experiences at a world-leading public university. My co-authored research on distributed systems and my leadership of a 5-person research team at UC Berkeley's RISE Lab demonstrate my ability to think critically about complex technical problems and communicate effectively with both technical and non-technical stakeholders.

I am particularly drawn to this role's balance of immediate technical leadership during the migration project and long-term ownership of BAMPFA's digital infrastructure. The opportunity to serve as the technical liaison between departments, manage integrations with Tessitura and CollectionSpace, and consult on data migration from legacy systems aligns perfectly with my experience architecting full-stack solutions and coordinating cross-functional teams.

I would welcome the opportunity to discuss how my technical expertise and collaborative approach can support BAMPFA's digital transformation. Thank you for your consideration.

Sincerely,
Kentaro Vadney